



ClimFin

Validation Workshop

(NOL & Finance Committee governance structure)

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Overview

The aim of this virtual workshop is to validate the proposed institutional structure and the no-objection procedure.

These documents were developed by ClimFin using information obtained during our in-person workshop and are intended to support and formalise existing country-level processes.

01

Eritrea No
Objection
Procedure

02

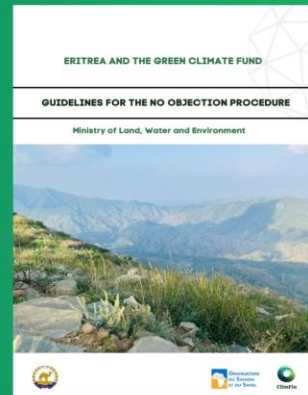
Eritrea Institutional
Climate Finance
Committee
Governance
Structure

03

ToR for Eritrea's
National
Designated
Authority



Part 1: Eritrea's No Objection Procedure (NOP)



- What is the NOP?
- Institutional Arrangements
- Review Procedures

Based on *Guidelines for the No Objection Procedure*



GCF No objection procedure (NOP)

The GCF governing instrument indicates that:

"Recipient countries may designate a national authority. This national designated authority [NDA] will recommend to the Board funding proposals in the context of national climate strategies and plans, including through consultation processes. The national designated authorities will be consulted on other funding proposals for consideration prior to submission to the Fund, to ensure consistency with national climate strategies and plans."

The **No Objection Procedure** (NOP) aims to ensure activities funded by GCF are consistent with national climate strategies and plans and to ensure country-driven approaches.

- Fit for purpose and country driven

The Green Climate Fund (**GCF** or the **Fund**) has established a *no objection* system to ensure that the activities funded by GCF are consistent with national climate strategies and plans and to ensure country-driven approaches. This no objection system is part of the Fund's efforts to ensure *country ownership* of all GCF-supported initiatives.

For the sake of clarity, GCF's no-objection mechanism is established by GCF's own "No-Objection Procedure" approved in GCF Board Decision B.08/10, as further updated by Decision B.42/02. In this document, the term "NOP" or "No-objection Procedure" refers to Eritrea's no-objection procedure developed to meet GCF's requirements.

A country's NDA is the main interlocutor between the country and GCF. The GCF governing instrument indicates that *"Recipient countries may designate a national authority. This national designated authority will recommend to the Board funding proposals in the context of national climate strategies and plans, including through consultation processes. The national designated authorities will be consulted on other funding proposals for consideration prior to submission to the Fund, to ensure consistency with national climate strategies and plans."* Therefore, each country

must establish a fit-for-purpose *no objection procedure* and have an NDA for accessing funding from GCF.

GCF's Governing Instrument, paragraph 46.

This means that each country is responsible for designing its own No-Objection Procedure in a manner consistent with its legal, administrative, and institutional context.



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Eritrea NDA – No objection procedure

- The issuance of a No-Objection Letter (NOL) is a mandatory step for the submission of any funding proposal (FP) to the GCF
- The NOL signifies that the Government of Eritrea, through its NDA, has reviewed and endorsed the proposal as consistent with the country's strategic frameworks and priorities.
- In line with GCF policy, any FP submitted to the GCF without a NOL will not be processed for Board consideration.



The issuance of a NOL is a mandatory step for the submission of any FP to the GCF. The NOL signifies that the Government of Eritrea, through its NDA, has reviewed and endorsed the proposal as consistent with the country's strategic frameworks and priorities. The letter is signed by the official NDA representative registered with the GCF Secretariat following internal review and clearance by relevant authorities. In line with GCF policy, any FP submitted to the GCF without a NOL will not be processed for Board consideration. A no-objection procedure therefore serves as a vital mechanism to uphold Eritrea's ownership of GCF-financed activities and to ensure the effectiveness, transparency, accountability, complementarity and coherence of all climate finance engagements in the country.

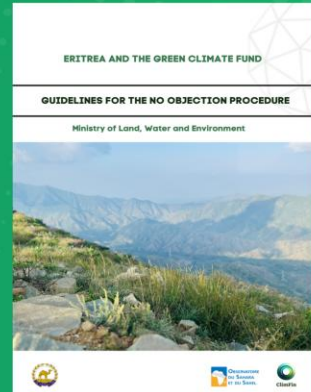


Eritrea – No objection procedure

Purpose: to ensure that all GCF concept notes (CNs) and funding proposals (FPs) are consistent with the country's national development agenda, climate strategies, and sectoral priorities, and ensure complementarity and coherence

The NOP covers the procedure for:

- Reviewing and endorsing concept notes (CNs) and issuing a Letter of Support (LOS) to be submitted to GCF.
- Reviewing and endorsing FPs and issuing a NOL to be submitted to GCF, and
- Reviewing and endorsing project preparation facility (PPF) CNs and issuing a NOL for PPF applications to GCF.



The purpose of Eritrea's **NOP** is to ensure that all GCF CNs and FPs are consistent with the country's national development agenda, climate strategies, and sectoral priorities, and ensure complementarity and coherence among the activities of various climate funds in similar sectors and themes within Eritrea. The NOP provides a structured and transparent process for stakeholder consultation and review, ensuring that government institutions, civil society organizations, academia, and development partners are engaged in assessing the relevance and potential impact of each proposed project interventions.

Scope. This NOP covers the procedure for:

- Reviewing and endorsing project CNs and issuing a Letter of Support (LOS) for CNs to be submitted to GCF. Although the GCF considers the CN a voluntary step, i.e. an accredited entity (AE) can directly submit a FP without first submitting a CN, this Eritrean NOP strongly encourages project proponents to submit their CNs for both GCF and NDA review. Any CN submitted requires a Letter of Support (LOS) from the NDA. This allows the NDA and key stakeholders to provide early feedback and ensure that proposals are aligned with national priorities before advancing to the FP stage.
- Reviewing and endorsing FPs and issuing a NOL for FPs to be submitted to

- GCF, and
- Reviewing and endorsing PPF CN and issuing a NOL for PPF applications to GCF.

This Procedure does not cover issuance of letter of confirmation for readiness and preparatory support program grant proposals to GCF or other letter of confirmation requested by GCF on a case-by-case basis.

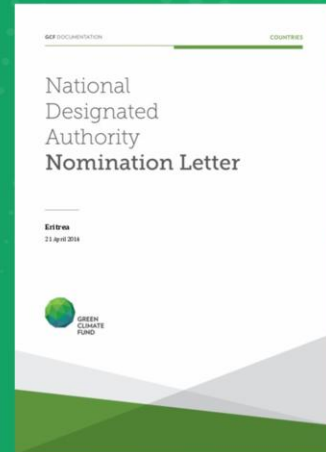


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Role of the NDA in the NOP

The NDA is the main implementer of this NOP and has the following main roles and responsibilities under the NOP:

- Acting as the official interface between the Government of Eritrea and the GCF, ensuring that CNs, FPs and PPF requests are consistent with national priorities, strategies and plans of Eritrea.
- Verify alignment of proposed project/program with Eritrea's climate change policies and priorities, strategies, and social objectives.
- No-objection communication/coordination between NDA and GCF.



The NDA is the main implementer of this NOP and has the following main roles and responsibilities under the NOP:

- Acting as the official interface between the Government of Eritrea and the GCF, ensuring that CNs, FPs and PPF requests are consistent with national priorities, strategies and plans of Eritrea.
- Verify alignment of proposed project/program with Eritrea's climate change policies and priorities, strategies, and social objectives. GCF guidelines expect NDAs to verify that the activities included in funding proposals are aligned with national climate-related and social (e.g. gender) policies and priorities through the no-objection procedure.
- No-objection communication/coordination between NDA and GCF, through the NDA representative registered at GCF. This includes issuance of a signed LOS for Concept Notes or NOL for Funding Proposals or PPF applications to the GCF Secretariat confirming that the CN, FP or PPF application, as applicable submitted to GCF conforms with the national priorities, strategies and plans of Eritrea, and that Eritrea's national process for ascertaining no-objection has been duly followed.

As outlined in GCF Decision B.08/10 and B.41/02



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Role of the NDA Secretariat in the NOP

The NDA Secretariat, as the implementation arm of the NDA, will provide necessary technical support for the implementation of this NOP. This includes:

- Provide technical advice and support on the NOP to relevant stakeholders, including accredited entities (AEs).
- Make available the relevant tools, including updated LOS and NOL templates and procedures, to AEs and project proponents.
- Provide other support as set out in the terms of reference (TOR) of the NDA Secretariat.



NDA Secretariat Organigram

The institutional arrangements described on this slide are part of Eritrea's fit-for-purpose, country-driven approach to establishing a no-objection procedure.

The NDA Secretariat, as the implementation arm of the NDA, will provide necessary technical support for the implementation of this NOP. This includes:

- Provide technical advice and support on the NOP to relevant stakeholders, including AEs.
- Make available the relevant tools, including updated LOS and NOL templates and procedures, to AEs and project proponents.
- Provide other support as set out in the TOR of the NDA Secretariat.



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Communication of No Objection to GCF

- Upon receipt of a CN, FP or PPF application from an AE or project proponent, the NDA Secretariat will (i) submit the CN, FP, or PPF application for national endorsement to the National Climate Change Steering Committee (NCCSC), and (ii) subsequently, conduct its no-objection assessment.
- After completion of the steps outlined in the NOP, if the proposal is endorsed by the NDA Focal Point, the NDA Secretariat will:
 - Prepare a LOS for CN, or an NOL for FP or the PPF application, as applicable;
 - Submit the LOS or NOL for signature by the Minister of Land, Water and Environment or the GCF/UNFCCC focal point, serving as the NDA representative registered with the GCF, and
 - Transmit the LOS or NOL to the AE.

Upon receipt of a CN or a FP or a PPF application from an AE or project proponents, the NDA Secretariat will (i) submit the Concept Note or Funding Proposal or the PPF application for national endorsement to the National Climate Change Steering Committee, and (ii) subsequently, conduct its no-objection assessment in line with established review criteria and coordination mechanisms, as outlined in sections F, G, and H below. The outcome of this assessment will be formally communicated to the relevant AE.

Following the procedures outlined sections F, G, and H of this document, if the proposal is endorsed by the NDA Focal Point, the NDA Secretariat will:

Prepare a LOS for CN, or an NOL for FP or the PPF application, as applicable;

Submit the LOS or NOL for signature by the Minister of Land, Water and Environment or the GCF/UNFCCC focal point, serving as the NDA representative registered with the GCF, and

Transmit the LOS or NOL to the AE.

By communicating a No-Objection Letter, the NDA confirms that:

The Government of Eritrea has no objections to the proposed project

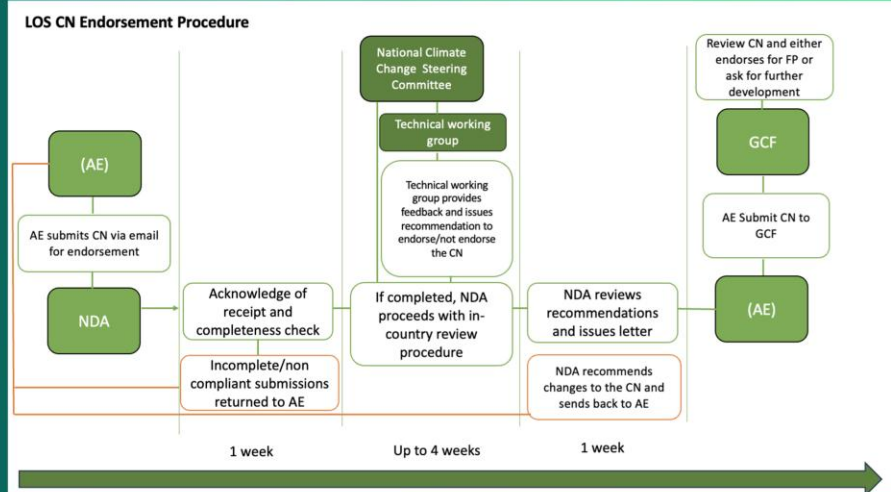
or programme;

The proposal aligns with national climate and development priorities, strategies, and plans and has undergone appropriate stakeholder consultations; and

The proposal complies with all relevant national laws, regulations, and environmental and social safeguards.



SOP for Concept Note Letter of Support



Step 1. Submission of Concept Note to NDA

AEs or project proponents submit to the NDA Secretariat a CN for appraisal and issuance of a LOS. The submission should be made via official email of the NDA Secretariat.

The submission email to (*placeholder for Eritrea NDA email address*) must include:

- A subject line titled "Submission of GCF Concept Note and Request for LoS."
- Identification of the AE and/or project proponent (if different), along with relevant partners.

Step 2. Acknowledgement and Completeness Check

- Upon receipt, the NDA Secretariat acknowledges via email the submission and conducts a completeness check, using Annex 3 of the Guidelines for the No Objection Procedure, within one week to ensure all sections of the GCF Concept Note template are filled in accurately and clearly.
- If the CN is incomplete, it will be returned to the AE or project proponent for clarification, additional information, or for re-submission starting from Step 1. Only complete submissions proceed to the appraisal stage.

Step 3. Appraisal and Review

Once the CN is deemed complete, the NDA Secretariat coordinates a structured simultaneous appraisal process, lasting a maximum of four weeks. The appraisal includes:

Technical and Country Priorities Review:

- The National Climate Change Steering Committee, comprising representatives from the line ministries and authorities as defined in the institutional framework, which will appoint a technical working team within one week.
- The technical working team, formed specifically for each CN, will review the technical soundness of the proposal.
- All reviewers will use the NDA's standardized LOS Form for Concept Notes as per Annex 4 of the Guidelines for the No Objection Procedure, which aligns with GCF investment criteria (impact potential, paradigm shift potential, sustainable development, needs of the recipient, country ownership, and efficiency/effectiveness). The LOS Form ensures that the NDA is measuring how the CN performs against Eritrea's national priorities and strategies.

Step 4. Compilation and Decision

After all appraisals are received, the National Climate Change Steering Committee compiles the recommendations into a summary report for submission to the NDA Focal Point for decision. The NDA Focal Point then reviews and decides within one week whether to endorse or reject the CN.

If endorsed, the NDA issues a LoS to the AE or project proponent on the LoS Form set out in Annex 1, confirming that the project concept aligns with national priorities and the NDA supports the concept to be developed to full proposal development. The LoS will note that any subsequent amendments to the Concept Note must be communicated by the AE or the project proponent to the NDA Secretariat in writing. If not endorsed, the NDA Secretariat will inform the AE/project proponent and provide a clear explanation, including anonymized feedback from reviewers where relevant.

Step 5. Submission to GCF

Once the CN receives the LoS, the AE submits the CN accompanied by the LoS to the GCF Secretariat for consideration.

The review of CN by GCF will be carried out in accordance with GCF's policies and procedure. If the CN is endorsed by GCF to develop a full FP, the procedure set out in Section H below will apply for NDA's review of FPs and issuance of NOL.



Annex 3: LoS Completeness Checklist for CNs

Summary the completeness of documents

Project/Programme Title	
Accredited Entity	
Executing Entity (s) (if any)	
Reviewer name (NDA)	
Documents status	Complete Not completed

Check-list	Status	Note
Section A Basic proposal Data (with special focus on alignment with country NDC and NAPs)	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section B Project/Programme Executive Summary	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section C Proposal Information (with special focus on country ownership, alignment with Eritrean priorities and strategies, and engagement with stakeholders)	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section D Indicative Financing Information	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section E Accredited/Executing Entity Information	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section F Key risks/mitigation measures	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section G Annexes:		
Map indicating location of the project	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Pre-feasibility study (with special focus on country ownership ensuring alignment with Eritrean priorities and strategies)	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Results of environmental and social risk screening	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Theory of change diagram	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	



Annex 4: LoS Assessment Checklist for CNs

Criteria	Assessment questions	Assessment results
Project Rationale	Does the project have a satisfactory climate rationale?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
	Is there sufficient evidence to support this, e.g., survey, report, pre-feasibility study, market analysis, scaling up of proven and viable technologies?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Project objective against the baseline	Has the objective of the project been clearly defined?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
	Is the project likely to improve the baseline scenario?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Impact Potential	Mitigation: Does the project contribute to a shift to low-emission sustainable development pathways e.g., CO ₂ e reduced due to the project, and/or cost effectiveness, i.e., total project cost compared to CO ₂ e reduced	☐ Yes ☐ Not applicable ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
	Adaptation: Does the project contribute to increased climate-resilient sustainable development e.g., number of direct/indirect beneficiaries, and/or beneficiaries relative to total population, total area benefited.	☐ Yes ☐ Not applicable ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:

Paradigm shift potential	Does the project have the potential to catalyze impact in the long term, and beyond the scope of the proposed project (potential for scaling-up and replication of the project, knowledge and learning, contribution to regulatory frameworks, policies and public planning, mobilization of other actors, market development and transformation)?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Sustainable development potential	Does the project have substantial content specific economic, social, environmental and gender sensitive development impact co-benefits? (examples include improved public health, improved energy security and improved forest ecosystem health)	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Needs of the recipient	Does the project reduce the level of exposure to climate risks and the degree of vulnerability, and address the needs and vulnerability of the beneficiary population or sector? Has a vulnerability assessment been conducted?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
	Does the project describe the country's financial, economic, social and institutional needs and the barriers to accessing domestic (public), private and other international sources of climate-related finance and outline how the proposed intervention will address the identified needs and barriers?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Country ownership	Is the proposal aligned with existing national policies, priorities, and strategies, such as the NDC, NAP, and LCP Country Programme?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
	Has the AE consulted all relevant stakeholders in the country/ies there a plan to consult with all relevant stakeholders during FP development?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Efficiency and effectiveness	Is the project economically and financially sound, taking into consideration the total funding requested, financing already or expected to be secured, any potential revenues and in-kind contributions?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:



Annex 4: LoS Assessment Checklist for CNs (con't)

Consultation and multi-stakeholder engagement	Has the project undertaken sufficient consultation by taking into consideration and involving all relevant stakeholders (including donors, private sector, provinces, local communities, and civil society)?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Potential overlaps / duplication, to be resolved (and suitability of location)	Is the project duplicating existing work?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
	Is it proposed that the project be implemented in an area that has already been supported by another project with same/similar activities?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
Exit Strategy	Is there an exit strategy and evidence that the project activities can be maintained after project funding?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:
	Have the maintenance and cost implications for the Government been sufficiently outlined?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need clarification Rationale and reference:



SOP for Project Preparation Facility (PPF)

Prior to submitting a PPF application to GCF, the AE must seek the NDA's review and appraisal of the PPF CN following the procedure set out in Section F of the Guidelines for the No Objection Procedure (*Standard Operating Procedures for Concept Note Review and Letter of Support Issuance*).

- **NOTE: PPF review will only proceed for concept notes that have already successfully passed through the LoS procedure**

If the NDA endorses the PPF CN following the review and appraisal of the PPF CN, it will issue an NOL based on the GCF's NOL template for PPF.

GCF DOCUMENTATION PROJECTS

Project Preparation Facility (PPF) Application

Concept note title		
Accredited Entity		
Countries)		
First submission	Click to enter the date of submission following endorsement of concept note	
Current submission	Click to enter a date	Version 000

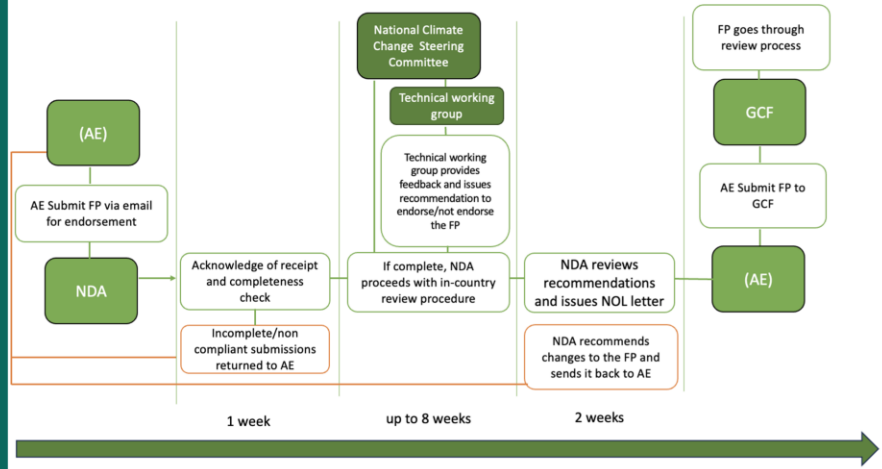
 GREEN CLIMATE FUND

Please submit the completed PPF application and the PPF no-objection letter to ppf@climate.org. Refer to the PPF Guidelines for further information on completing the PPF application.



SOP for Funding Proposal and No Objection Letter

NOL FP Endorsement Procedure



The GCF requires that all funding proposals submitted to the GCF be accompanied by a NOL issued by the NDA. This slide describes Eritrea's procedure for reviewing funding proposals and issuing NOLs.

Step 1. Submission of Funding Proposal to the NDA

The AE submits the complete FP package to the NDA Secretariat via official email or another (placeholder for Eritrea NDA email address) or another agreed method, such as flash drive. The submission must include:

- Full Funding Proposal (using the latest GCF FP template) and its mandatory annexes set out in GCF FP template;
- Endorsement or support letters from relevant line ministries.
- The email subject line must state: "Submission of GCF Funding Proposal and Request for No-Objection Letter (NOL)".

Step 2. Acknowledgement and Completeness Check

Upon receipt, the NDA Secretariat acknowledges the submission via email and conducts a completeness check within one week to ensure all sections of the GCF FP template and annexes are filled in accurately and clearly.

If the submission is deemed incomplete, it is returned to the AE with a written

request for clarification or additional information.

Step 3. Appraisal and Technical Review

Once the FP is accepted as complete, the NDA Secretariat initiates the **review and appraisal process**. Similar to the CN appraisal if the FP is complete, then NDA will request the technical team that reviewed the CN to reconvene in order to appraise the FP.

The appraisal uses the NDA Appraisal Template in Annex 6 of the Guidelines for the No Objection Procedure and is based on the GCF investment criteria. The appraisal can take place remotely and/or through one or more meetings as needed and arranged by the NDA secretariat (up to 8 weeks).

All evaluators must declare any perceived or actual conflicts of interest to the NDA and if needed may be asked to withdraw from evaluating the FP in question (for example if the evaluator will be involved in implementing the project). Evaluators may be asked to sign a non-disclosure agreement if requested by the AE/project proponent.

All evaluators will use the FP Appraisal Template (Annex 6) and submit their recommendations to the National Climate Change Steering Committee. The National Climate Change Steering Committee compiles all appraisals and recommendations, summarises outcomes and submits to the NDA with a recommendation to endorse or not endorse.

To avoid conflicts within the National Climate Change Steering Committee, the NDA process should aim for consensus-based decision-making, with a majority vote as a fallback when consensus is not reached.

The AE should provide clear justification for why a project is submitted and prioritized.

Step 4. Compilation and Decision

The NDA Focal Point reviews the National Climate Change Steering Committee recommendations and accordingly:

- If the NDA agrees with the Committee and decides to endorse the FP, the NDA will issue a NOL to the AE. The NOL is issued with the understanding that all subsequent considerable amendments to the FP after the NOL has been issued must be made known to the NDA by the AE in writing.
- If the FP is not endorsed, the NDA will inform the AE/project proponent and provide a clear explanation according to the feedback and recommendations received during the appraisal process.

Step 5. Submission to GCF

Under the GCF's no-objection system:

- The GCF Secretariat formally acknowledges the receipt of the NOL to both the

NDA and the AE/project proponent.

- If a full proposal is submitted to the GCF without an accompanying NOL, the GCF Secretariat informs the NDA that the proposal cannot be processed further until the NDA provides the NOL for the proposal.
- The NDA is required to provide its no-objection within 30 days after receiving this information from GCF. After the passage of 30 day GCF suspends the proposal and notifies the relevant AE.
- To promote transparency and accountability, GCF makes all issued NOLs and related communications publicly available through the GCF website.



Annex 5: NOL Completeness Checklist for FPs

Summary the completeness of documents

Project/Programme Title	
Accredited Entity	
Executing Entity (s) (if any)	
Date of Submission	
Date of Review	
Reviewer name (NDA)	
Documents status	Complete ☐ Not completed ☐

Summary of consultations and stakeholder engagement plan	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Gender assessment and project/programme-level action plan	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Legal Due Diligence	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Procurement plan	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Monitoring and evaluation plan	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Co-financing commitment letter, if applicable	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	

Check-list	Status	Note
Concept note (If any)	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Funding proposal	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section A Project/Programme Summary	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section B Project/Programme Information	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section C Financing Information	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section D Expected Performance Against Investment Criteria	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section E Logical Framework	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section F Risk assessment and management	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section G GCF Policies and standards	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Section H Annexes:		
Feasibility study - and a market study, if applicable	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Economic and/or financial analyses in spreadsheet format	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
Implementation timetable including key project/programme milestones	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	
E&S document corresponding to the E&S category (A, B or C; or I1, I2 or I3)	☐ Complete ☐ Not Complete	



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Annexes of the No Objection Procedure

01

Annex 1. LOS Template

Annex 1 of the NOL Procedure is the Letter in Support for Concept Notes

02

Annex 2. NOL Template

Annex 2 is the GCF template for No Objection Letter for both Funding Proposals and Project Preparation Facility.

03

Annex 3. LOS Completeness check

Annex 3 proposes a completeness checklist to be used by the NDA Secretariat when assessing concept notes completeness.

04

Annex 4. LOS Appraisal template for CNs

Annex 4 proposed a standardized review form for Concept Notes to be used by reviewers

05

Annex 5. NOL Completeness checklist for FPs

Annex 5 proposes a completeness checklist to be used by the NDA Secretariat when assessing funding proposals completeness

06

Annex 6. NOL Appraisal template for FPs

Annex 6 proposed a standardized review form for Funding Proposals to be used by reviewers



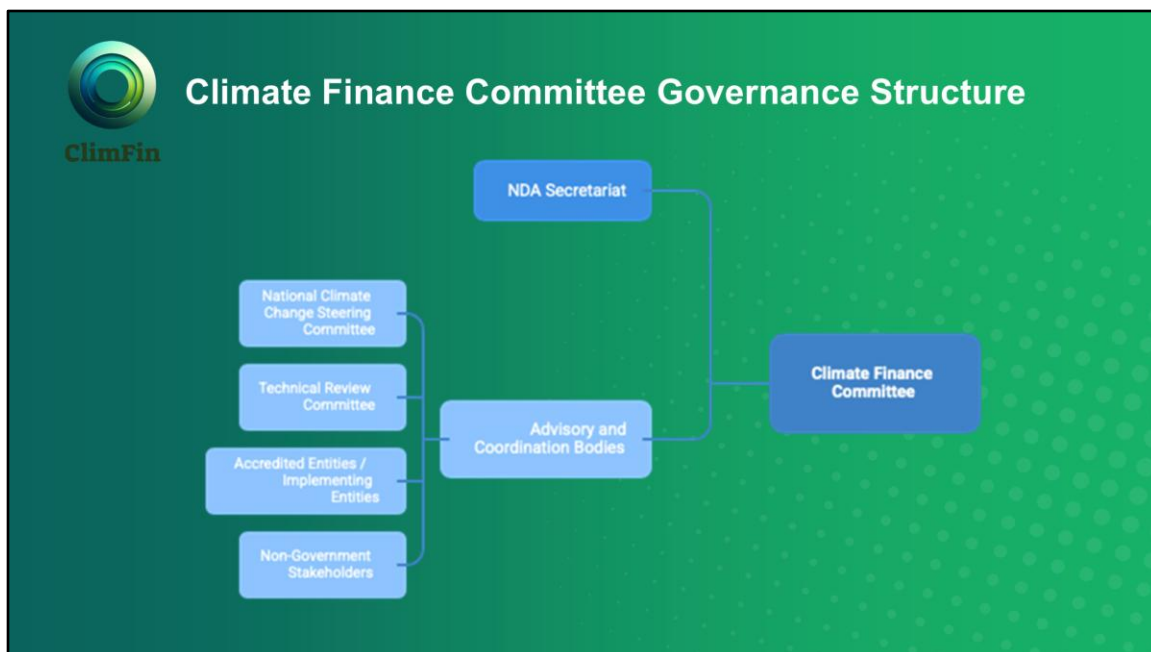
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DISCUSSION OF NOL PROCEDURE



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Part 2: Eritrea Institutional Climate Finance Committee Governance Structure



To effectively perform its role as the National Designated Authority (NDA) to the Green Climate Fund (GCF), Eritrea requires an institutional framework that ensures strategic oversight, cross-sector coordination, and operational efficiency.

The framework described here is designed to align with GCF requirements while being adapted to Eritrea's institutional context and national climate governance structures.

The **Climate Finance Committee** is the overall institutional mechanism for coordinating matters related to climate finance in Eritrea. It comprises two types of entities:

- **Functional.** The functional entity is the NDA Secretariat, which handles the day-to-day work of the NDA.
- **Advisory/coordination bodies.** This includes stakeholders that provide technical inputs to inform the NDA's work, including the review of funding proposals. It also includes entities that the NDA engages with as it fulfills its various functions.

These will be elaborated on in the next slide.



Table Summary of Actors and Responsibilities

Actor	Key Responsibilities
NDA Secretariat	Communication with GCF; stakeholder convening; developing/updating Country Programme & project pipeline; approving DAEs/accreditation; no-objection issuance; pre-screening; coordinating technical review; readiness/institutional strengthening; M&E and reporting; knowledge management.
National Climate Change Steering Committee	Strategic endorsement of national climate finance priorities; inter-ministerial coordination; mobilisation of co-finance; oversight/review.
Technical Review Committee	Technical appraisal of proposals; multi-stakeholder input; knowledge sharing; meetings and follow-up.
Accredited & Implementing Entities	Proposal development & implementation; compliance with GCF fiduciary & safeguard standards; reporting to NDA; stakeholder engagement; capacity building.
Non-government stakeholders (CSO/Private/Academia/Communities)	Participation in consultations; feedback and representation; ensuring gender/social inclusion; contribution of expertise; monitoring and dissemination.

Climate Finance Committee: The Climate Finance Committee (CFC) serves as the central coordinating body for Eritrea’s overall response to climate change. It is responsible for strategic decision-making on policies, planning, and programming related to climate finance and climate action. Under the auspices of the CFC, several subsidiary bodies and committees provide advisory guidance, operational support, and execution of specific climate finance initiatives. These bodies are the NDA secretariat and advisory bodies such as the national climate change steering committee, the technical review committee, accredited and implementing entities and non government stakeholders.

NDA Secretariat: The NDA Secretariat is hosted by the Ministry of Land, Water and Environment (MoLWE). It acts as the central operational hub for the country’s interface with the GCF, enabling coordination, pipeline development, stakeholder engagement, monitoring, reporting, and communication. Core Responsibilities as per GCF mandate: The Minister of Land, Water and Environment and the GCF & UNFCCC Focal Point are the NDA signatory for the No Objection Letter (NOL). Upon proposal appraisal through application of the review process in consultation with the Steering Committee, the Minister or the GCF Focal point will provide final approval and endorsement of the NOL.

In addition to the review of CNs and FPs, which was described in Section 1 of this presentation, the NDA Secretariat also supports other NDA functions. These include:

- Nomination of Direct Access entities for accreditation. This involves identifying and supporting national and sub-regional institutions with potential for GCF accreditation.
- Country programming and pipeline development. This involves leading the development and periodic updating of the GCF country program, which presents Eritrea's climate change priorities with the GCF and outlines a pipeline of projects.
- Institutional strengthening and readiness. This involves identifying and prioritizing areas where capacity building and readiness support are needed, and requesting support under the GCF's Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme
- Communication, Coordination, and Stakeholder engagement. This involves serving as the central liaison with the GCF Board and Secretaria, as well as sharing information and coordinating with in-country stakeholders
- Monitoring, reporting, and oversight. This involves maintaining a database of GCF activities in Eritrea, as well as a database of national consultations and stakeholder engagements.

Advisory and Coordination Bodies

3a. National Climate Change Steering Committee: Chair: MoLWE

Overall Role: An inter-ministerial committee which is responsible for overseeing and guiding the implementation of climate change activities in Eritrea. Its tasks are to provide strategic oversight, policy direction and ensure high-level coherence of the climate finance agenda across sectors and ministries. This committee also will periodically appoint Technical Review Committee (TRC) members from its constituent line ministries for the purpose of reviewing project concepts and funding proposals submitted to the NDA (see details below).

Members: Key ministries, authorities, and other government entities (Finance, Agriculture, Energy and Mines, Health, National Development, Forestry and Wildlife Authority, Marine Resources, Local Government, Transport and Communications, Civil Aviation Department Meteorological Services Agency), Civil society and AF/GEF focal point.

3b. Technical Review Committee (TRC)

Overall Role: Act as technical evaluators and platforms for multi-stakeholder input to ensure that proposals are technically sound, aligned with national policy, socially inclusive and environmentally robust.

Members: Experts from relevant ministries, academia, technical institutions, and CSOs.

3c. Accredited Entities / Implementing Entities

Overall Role: Responsible for the development and implementation of GCF-funded projects/programmes, in partnership with the NDA and national stakeholders.

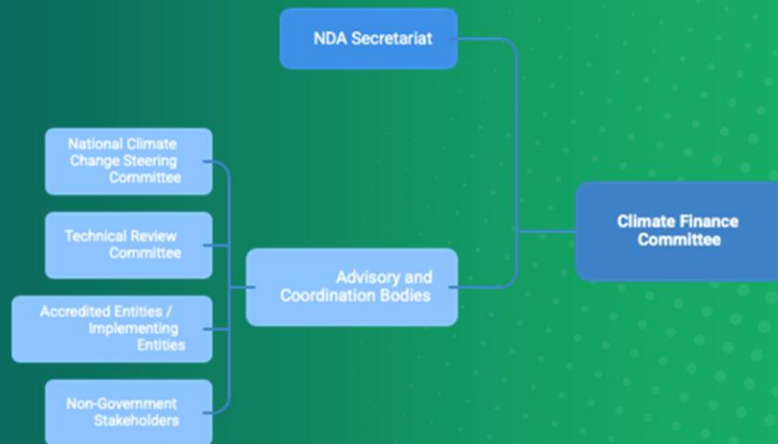
3d. Non-Government stakeholders (Civil Society, Academia, Private Sector)

Overall Role: Ensure meaningful participation of broader society in the climate finance process, enhancing legitimacy, innovation and country ownership.



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Part 3: Eritrea NDA TORs



Overview of NDA Secretariat ToRs

- NDA Secretariat supports day-to-day functioning of the NDA
- Housed in MoLWE
- Comprises technical, policy, and administrative personnel

Core responsibilities of the NDA include:

- Proposal review and quality assurance (*NOP*)
- Strategic oversight to ensure funding proposals are aligned with national priorities (*NOP*)
- National No-Objection Procedure management
- Identifying and nominating entities for direct access accreditation to the GCF
- Country programming and pipeline development
- Institutional strengthening and readiness
- Communication, coordination, and stakeholder engagement
- Monitoring, reporting, and oversight

As noted in Part 1, the NDA Secretariat has been established within MoLWE to support the day-to-day operations of the NDA. It comprises technical, policy, and administrative personnel. The NDA Secretariat ensures transparent decision-making and endorsement processes, upholds national ownership of all GCF-financed projects and readiness support, maintains coherence with national climate change priorities and development goals, and carries out the day-to-day functions of the nDA as the bridge between GCF and national stakeholders



Composition of the NDA



NDA Secretariat personnel will be seconded from existing staff within the MoLWE and will therefore remain subject to MoLWE's established human resource management policies and procedures.

Staff will be appointed by the NDA Director (Head of Unit) for an open-ended term, the duration of which will be determined at the discretion of the NDA Director.

Certain tasks (e.g., environmental and social safeguards) may be delegated to other government offices with the requisite technical capacities

NDA Director (Head of Unit)

Mandate: The NDA Director provides strategic, technical, and operational leadership to the NDA Secretariat, overseeing Eritrea's engagement with GCF. The NDA Director ensures that all GCF-related processes are transparent, efficient, compliant with national laws and regulations as well as GCF requirements, and aligned with national climate and development priorities

D.2 GCF Coordinator (Communication Appointee)

Mandate: The GCF Coordinator serves as the official liaison between the Government of Eritrea and the Green Climate Fund (GCF). The role ensures timely, accurate, and transparent flow of information between the NDA Secretariat, national stakeholders, Accredited Entities (AEs), Delivery Partners, and the GCF Secretariat. The GCF Coordinator supports communication, documentation, coordination, and procedural compliance across all GCF-related activities.

D.3 Technical Officer

Mandate: The Technical Officer provides high-level policy, technical, and strategic guidance to ensure that all GCF-related activities are fully aligned with Eritrea's national climate strategies, sectoral priorities, and international commitments. The role coordinates technical assessments, supports cross-ministerial engagement, and ensures the integration of climate science, policy frameworks, and safeguards into all GCF engagements.

D.4 Technical Assistant (TA)

Purpose: The Technical Assistance (TA) position provides analytical, technical, and operational support to the NDA Secretariat across all GCF-related functions, including proposal review, pipeline development, accreditation support, readiness implementation, stakeholder engagement, and information management. The TA supports the technical strengthening of national institutions and ensures that GCF processes are implemented efficiently, transparently, and in line with national priorities.

D.5 Information Technology Specialist

Purpose: To provide technical and operational support for the NDA Secretariat's IT systems, ensuring effective digital infrastructure, data management, and information security to support the NDA's climate finance functions.



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Indicative responsibilities of Secretariat personnel

NDA Director (Head of Unit)

- Strategic leadership and planning; External engagement; team management and supervision
- Supervise NOP, Readiness, and Accreditation functions
- Oversee stakeholder consultation and pipeline development processes

GCF Coordinator

- Communications and correspondence management; information dissemination and stakeholder outreach
- Information management
- National No-Objection Procedure management

Technical Officer

- PoC on national strategies and policies
- Technical assessment of CNs and FPs
- Technical coordination with line ministries and agencies
- Technical inputs for assessments, monitoring and evaluation, pipeline development, and accreditation

Technical Assistant

- Logistical and admin support for NOP
- Pipeline and readiness technical backstopping
- Tracking potential accredited entities
- Tracking stakeholder engagement processes

Information Technology Specialist

- IT infrastructure management and systems admin
- Knowledge management and data systems
- Capacity building and IT guidance



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DISCUSSION OF NDA Secretariat ToRs





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Thank You!

Any questions?



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